

DOWNTOWN

Sunday
September 13, 2026

THE HINDU

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



BALMANDAISA

ELEPHANDAISA FOUND A HOME IN BALMANDAISA

DACTM
DREAM ASCEND CONQUER

NOW HAPPILY LIVING A LARGER LIFE

GRAND LAUNCH

13 & 14
SEPTEMBER 2026



**PORUR - POONAMALLEE
MAIN ROAD**

2 & 3 BHK
4 & 5 BHK DUPLEX
ULTRA-LUXURY RESIDENCES

₹1.19 Cr
ONWARDS

194
UNITS

40+
AMENITIES

2 BASEMENT LEVELS
+ STILT + 13 FLOORS



TNRERA/29/BLG/0321/2026
dated 07.09.2026
www.rera.tn.gov.in

93003 93003



BALMANDAISA



TNRERA/29/BLG/0321/2026
dated 07.09.2026
www.rera.tn.gov.in



VISIT OUR
MODEL
HOUSE

BUILT ON THE BELIEF THAT

HOME MATTERS



DREAM ASCEND CONQUER



SIGNATURE AMENITIES

- | | |
|--|---|
|  Podium Swimming Pool |  She Corner |
|  Coworking Space |  Mini Theatre |
|  Multipurpose Hall |  Indoor Games Room |
|  Rooftop Party Area |  Zumba |

Where Everyday
LIVING
FEELS LIKE A
BREAK

Podium
Swimming Pool

The
MERIDIAN

Shared Spaces,
Meaningful Connections

Clubhouse



LOCATION ADVANTAGES



Seamless City Connectivity

- > Upcoming Kumananchavadi Metro Station - 75 m
- > Porur - Sri Ramachandra Hospital - 2.8 Km
- > Karayanchavadi Bus Stand - 1.2 Km



Convenience, Close By

- > D Mart - 350 m
- > Saveetha Dental College & Hospital - 1 Km



Close to Work Hubs

- > L&T Infotech – 7.3 km
- > DLF Cyber City – 7.3 km
- > Fintech City – 8.9 km



THERE IS NO PLACE
LIKE HOME.
THERE IS NO HOME
LIKE DAC.

AR Ramesh

SCAN TO
KNOW MORE



Disclaimer: Images, elevations, interiors, amenities, lifestyle visuals and mascot representations are for illustrative purposes only; actual specifications, layouts, finishes and surroundings may vary. Prices and availability are subject to change, distances are approximate, statutory/other charges are extra, and T&C apply.

Call 93003 93003

No. 19, K-Block, A-1 Ground Floor, Anna Nagar East, Chennai - 600 102.

www.dacdevelopers.com

Follow us on  

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



'SAFETY GEAR IS NOW THE MAJOR GROSSER'

Sydenhams Road supports a section of the unorganised sector that only continues to thrive and grow bigger due to a variety of intrinsic factors **P3**



30 SCHOOLS TAKE PART IN MANAGEMENT CONCLAVE

This is the silver jubilee edition of the inter-school event organised by Department of Business Administration, Madras Christian College **P5**

Sewage stagnation raises a stink

Along the western side of Chitlapakkam Lake this is a serious concern that residents want addressed at the earliest

T. ARVIND

Residents of Tambaram Corporation's Zone 3 have urged the civic body to take immediate steps to clear a blocked drainage outlet that has resulted in sewage stagnation along the western side of Chitlapakkam Lake and the rear section of Kannagi Street.

In a memorandum submitted to the Commissioner, Tambaram City Municipal Corporation, the Tambaram Corporation Zone 3 Residents Welfare Association said waste water from Chitlapakkam 2nd Main Road, the TB Hospital area and Periyar Street was flowing through an existing drainage route behind Periyar Street, adjoining the lakeside stretch. Waste water from East Tambaram also joins the same route and flows towards one end of Kannagi Street, it said.

According to S.M. Govindarajan, president, Tambaram Corporation Zone 3 Residents Welfare Association, the outlet at the Kannagi Street end is currently blocked or closed, preventing waste water from flowing further and resulting in stagnation along the upstream stretches.

The stagnation has led to foul odour and mosquito breeding. There is also the concern of contamination of soil and groundwater and the resultant public-health risks, Govindarajan said.

The association has also sought immediate desilting and rectifica-



The drainage route at the Kannagi Street-Periyar Street junction is choked and blocked causing the sewage to stagnate as it cannot flow forward.
PHOTO: T. ARVIND

tion of the canal along Judge Colony 2nd Main Road. It may be recalled that *The Hindu Downtown* had highlighted on June 21, 2026, the issue of sewage and rainwater sharing 'chambers' in Judge Colony.

However, no action has been taken by the Corporation so far, Govindarajan said.

Residents seek joint inspection

The residents have urged the Corporation to conduct a joint inspection involving its Engineering and Public Health/Sanitary teams to assess the drainage route and identify the obstruction.

They have sought removal of the blockage and desilting of the af-

ected drainage route, besides restoration of a safe and continuous flow to the authorised sewerage/drainage system.

The association has specifically requested that steps be taken to ensure that untreated sewage does not enter Chitlapakkam Lake.

As an interim measure, the Corporation has been urged to arrange pumping, cleaning and disinfection wherever necessary until a permanent solution is implemented. Govindarajan has also sought a permanent engineering solution to prevent recurrence of the problem and requested the Corporation to share details of the proposed remedial measures and timeline for execution.



Will an opening at this junction in Adambakkam help?

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Motorists traversing Thillai Ganga Nagar 23rd Street (towards Medavakkam Main Road in Adambakkam) want Greater Chennai Traffic Police and the State Highways Department to create an opening on Southern Sector Inner Ring Road (SSIRR) opposite Jeevan Nagar Second Street.

As per the traffic rule, motorists from Saint Thomas Mount and Adambakkam regions, proceeding towards Nanganallur should either negotiate Thillai Ganga Nagar (TGN) Fourth Main Road and Fifth Main Road or Jeevan Nagar Second Street and take a U-turn on Ring Road along TGN 23rd Street.

The other option is to negotiate Medavakkam Main Road and Ring Road and take a U-turn near Vanuvampet Gandhi Street on Ring Road and through Vanuvampet.

S. Jayaraj, a motorist, says, "Motorists drive in the wrong direction towards Ring Road. The road is not wide enough for two-way traffic, and this practice further reduces its usable width. During rush hour, traffic congestion occurs, and there are no traffic police personnel deployed to address the issue."

Only Light Vehicular Movement Traffic should be allowed at the junction to prevent accidents.



Wrong side driving at Thillai Ganga Nagar 23rd Street.

Road surface ‘peels off’

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Motorists frequenting a section of First Main Road and N S Krishnan Road in Nanganallur and Vanuvampet have requested the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board and the Greater Chennai Corporation to relay the stretches.

At two points on First Main Road, the carriageway is entirely battered. Broken surfaces adorn Ram Nagar First Main Road and N S Krishnan Road.

Months ago, the board undertook work to replace the old underground drainage pipelines and completed it two months ago.

A stretch of First Main Road in Nanganallur.

This was followed by concreting of the work areas, but it soon gave way.

The concrete surface is covered with cuts and bruises. Even the tar road surface is getting damaged.

N. Lingesh, a fruit vendor, who commutes every day through the stretch, said, “A

number of accidents have occurred due to the uneven surfaces. Tires get punctured and shock absorbers damaged.”

S. Madhumathi, a motorist, said, “The patchwork was not carried out properly, and was done only a couple of months ago.”

READERS WRITE

‘Construct UGD network to save lakes’

P. VISWANATHAN

With the State government having granted administrative sanction for the Underground Drainage (UGD) system covering Chitlapakkam, the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation should float tenders at the earliest to start the work.

Since 2000, residents of the region have been demanding that the State government construct an underground drainage network. At present, the storm-water drain network in the region carries sewage to the lakes.

El Niño can cause water scarcity. Under these circumstances,

collecting, storing, and protecting rainwater in lakes and recharging groundwater are important.

To protect rainwater and groundwater, the UGD network should be implemented immediately.

The Tambaram City Municipal Corporation and the State Government must take steps to ensure that sewage does not enter the water bodies. The lakes should be desilted to increase their storage capacity and store maximum rainwater.

P. Viswanathan is a resident of Chitlapakkam and convener of Chitlapakkam Residents Associations Coordination Committee

‘Remove the hoarding along the junction’

V. YOGANAND

Residents have raised objection to a new advertisement hoarding installed at Chitlapakkam junction, near the water tank. To be specific, this structure is at the junction of Chitlapakkam First Main Road, Chitlapakkam Second Main Road and Chitlapakkam Third Main Road.

A large number of motorists travelling towards Tambaram Sanatorium, Anna Street, Nehru Street, Chitlapakkam Third Main Road and MIT Flyover cross this junction.

Installing a large advertisement structure here obstructs visibility



and distracts motorists.

I request the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation to inspect the advertisement hoarding structure and the permissions granted for its installation.

Take appropriate action to remove the structure from the present location.

If permitted under the applicable

regulations, relocate the advertisement structure to a safer and more suitable location, such as an appropriate roadside location away from a major junction or on the top/side of a suitable building, without obstructing traffic visibility.

V. Yoganand is the secretary of Chitlapakkam Muthulakshmi Nagar Welfare Association

‘Introduce bus routes from Mappedu region’

A. V. NARAYANAN

The Metropolitan Transport Corporation bus routes from Tambaram (East and West) bus terminuses connect T. Nagar, Sholingnallur, Siruseri, Perungudi, Thiruvannamiyur, Adyar, Velachery, Keezhkattalai, and Kovilambakkam regions via Major Mukund Varadarajan Road. But no bus connects Mappedu directly with the above mentioned areas. Commuters have to board buses from Camp Road, which is difficult for senior citizens. I request MTC to provide direct connectivity to these areas via Thiruvanchery and Bharat University from Mappedu by operating new routes.

A. V. Narayanan is a resident of Thiruvanchery

‘Secretariat at Race Course’

P. SATHYANARAYANAN

Recently, C. Joseph Vijay, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, announced in the State Assembly that the new Secretariat and Legislative Assembly complex will be built at Foreshore Estate.

The announcement faces resistance from fishermen residing in the Estate and political parties.

I request that the State Government consider constructing the Secretariat in the Guindy Race Course land. The previous State government has reclaimed the land. The Guindy region has good transport infrastructure and is close to Raj Bhavan.

P. Sathyanarayanan is a resident of Guindy

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.





LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Sydenham Road in Periamet is the “wardrobe” for blue collar workers. On this oft-crowded thoroughfare, from the point where the Greater Chennai Corporation’s headquarters (Ripon Building) begins to the point where the Nehru stadium almost ends, around thirty shops, some found in a cluster and others spaced apart, provide passersby with a peek into this wardrobe.

There is something for almost every front-line worker under the sun. Uniform for security personnel; safety jackets for those working amidst traffic; safety helmets for construction workers; gear tailored for house keeping staff and conservancy workers; shoes, boots, caps and belts associated with the police force; general caps; and laboratory coats. Do not let that “and” hoodwink the reader into thinking this list is exhaustive. It hardly is. Bulk orders placed by corporates government agencies, education institutions and construction companies among others as well as individual purchases sustain this business. And for novelty, orders sometimes fly in from cricket leagues and franchises.

This visual side to Sydenham Road is familiar for old timers; and it remains its dominant feature. For the superficial eye, little has changed. Can that be said about the eye that has been taking in this “scenery”, day in day out, for years, and even decades? Has anything in the market shifted significantly? As it was established in 1945, United Uniform is probably at an advantage while taking that question. It operates from a shop built into the historic Periamet mosque, established in 1838 by hides and skins traders. After Independence, the mosque would go

‘Safety gear is now the major grosser’

Sydenham Road, dubbed “the Blue Collar Uniform Hub of Chennai”, supports a section of the unorganised sector that only continues to thrive and grow bigger due to a variety of intrinsic factors



through two reconstruction exercises, and that would give birth to these shops, partly defining the lower reaches of the mosque on one side. Kahifullah Khan, the third generation owner of United Uniform, observes this shop was constructed in 1956. At that time, United Uniform was functioning from what was called ‘Red Building’ in Moore Market with the foun-

der and Kahifullah’s grandfather, Hafizullah Khan at the helm. Kahifullah recalls that the enterprise shifted to its current location in the early 1980s following the much-discussed Moore Market fire, an event that led to the scattering of Moore Market traders dealing in various goods to the nooks and crannies of Madras.

On the question of changes, Ka-

Sydenham Road and an old unorganised business that is still going strong.



hifullah draws attention to the facade of his shop and those of others in the mosque complex. These shops are noticeably below road level, even coming across as basement shops. With a barely concealed chuckle, he remarks that these shops were once above road level; successive road-laying exercises have got them where they are. In every other aspect, according to him, these small enterprises constituting a segment of the unauthorised sector have been on an upward trajectory.

“There are now more shops in this line of business than ever before,” states Kahifullah, adding the changes have had to do with the major buyers’ mindset, and thankfully, meeting those new expectations is hardly a tough ask.

On the dominant category sold by these shops through the decades, Kahifullah points out that in the 1980s, the focus was largely on police-related products and then a shift happened, greater attention now being accorded to medical items, the coats, then NCC and Scouts uniform and accessories. From the 2010s, safety gear is the major grosser: safety shoes, jackets and helmets easily constitute the highest selling category, he states. Yet another noticeable shift has to do with the choice of material for the making of shoes. Around 15 to 17 years ago, the scales tipped in favour of rexine over leather. And Kahifullah believes this change has been driven primarily by “large-scale manufacturing of rexine in Gujarat and Haryana. Some people even import rexine from Korea and China.”

If one parsed through the resilience of these shops, one factor emerges strongly, a bond that goes beyond a common trade. Kahifullah puts a ballpark number on the shops in this line of business on Sydenham road, thirty-five, and adds that out of that, around 90 percent of them are run by those

that are part of his extended family. He admits there is competitive pricing, but there is also cooperation. In this climate, sourcing items not in one’s stock from others is possible.

One senses a strong sense of connection and continuity best epitomised by Kahifullah himself. He is essentially a techie, having had a long stint in the IT industry, and he peeled himself from it to keep a family legacy going. He joined this business four years ago following his father Shafifullah’s death in 2022.

The narrative about connections and continuity gains greater ground as more conversations are initiated with these tradespeople. At Khaleel Cap Mart, a misnomer as they sell uniform and accessories in addition to caps, Quraishi, 45, who first came to the shop at age 12, during his school days, remarks that the

Old Markets, New Trends

This column features markets that have continued to retain their hold on people’s mind space despite the shifting sands of fads. Through entities that have been around for a long time, it seeks to find out what makes these markets tick

name ‘Cap Mart’ is a reminder of those early years. The shop originally specialised in caps, from turbans and Muslim prayer caps or Kufis, to Kashmiri caps. As customer requirements changed. So did the shop’s inventory. One of the shop’s most distinctive products is not necessarily the most conspicuous. Its cotton mosquito nets are made in the traditional way and remain popular among police personnel at various police residential quarters. Depending on the bed type, they cost between ₹500 and ₹1,500. Started by Khaleel Ur Rahman, the shop is now run by Quraishi and his brother Nayeem. Quraishi echoes Kahifullah’s sentiment that this business is on an even keel.

Speaking for the tradespeople in his line of business on Sydenham Road, Quraishi observes digital buying has left no dent in their business. “Individuals might buy a cap online; for bulk orders, they come to us.”

G. SOORIYAMOORTHY
AT WORK

The nuts and bolts of creativity

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

At first glance, it resembles a pile of wires. On closer look, the contours of a face become evident. That is the idea behind G. Sooriyamoorthy's "The Imaginative Metal Wire Portrait of an Artist", one of two sculptures he is preparing for Aurae Elemental, an art show where he will stage his experiments with unconventional materials and painstaking techniques spanning 26 years. His second work, "Within the Armour", engaged with a different material and manages a distinct effect: nuts and bolts assembled into the form of a warrior.

The works might differ in appearance, but both reflect Sooriyamoorthy's preference for materials that demand time, precision and physical effort.

"People ask me why I am using

Sculptor G. Sooriyamoorthy promotes the idea of "art made difficult"; and there is a method to this madness. His works will be on display at Lalit Kala Akademi from October 10 to 15

metal wire when it is so time-consuming," he says. His welding shop is in Tambaram, requiring him to travel back and forth from his home in Ayanavaram as he works on the sculptures. "People ask why I put in so much effort when there are easier ways of creating art. For me, the effort is part of the process."

To reach its final form, the wire

portrait consumed three months. The idea came from drawing: Sooriyamoorthy imagined a face made up of multiple lines, with each wire functioning like a line on paper. Instead of lying flat, however, the lines intersect and move through space, gradually forming the figure.

The process involved little machinery. Using cutting pliers, he cut, stretched and tightened the wires before weaving them together. Continuous work for even 30 minutes to an hour could leave his hands hurting. The ponytail was particularly demanding, with individual wires cut to different lengths and shaped by hand. "No large machines were used," he says. A small skull-like structure sits at the centre of the composition, helping hold the interwoven wires together. The construction, which resembles basket-making, gives the sculpture stability despite the thin material. The metal was also treated to achieve an antique finish.

His second sculpture began with a different challenge. Sooriyamoorthy had been looking for an opportunity to experiment with nuts and bolts when he conceived the idea of a warrior. But before he could begin welding, he had to work out the figure itself. He first made a clay model, shaping and carving the anatomy while leaving spaces for the nuts and bolts to fit. The model was then used to make a plaster of Paris mold.

The choice of plaster was practical. Welding generates considerable heat, and Sooriyamoorthy says plaster of Paris absorbs the heat and helps keep the metal cool. Fibre, another material that is generally used for larger sculptures, could pose a fire risk under welding conditions. The nuts and bolts were welded from inside the sculpture. For the warrior's hair, he used 8 mm metal rods, bending and shaping them before welding them into place. The clay model was started around four months ago, while the welding took four days.

"I was able to finish it in a short

An eclectic mix of artists

Aurae Elemental, an art exhibition featuring artists at different stages of their creative journeys, will be held from 10 to 15 October 2026 at Lalit Kala Akademi, Thousand Lights. The exhibition, which will be inaugurated on October 9, at 5.30 p.m., brings together emerging artists, first-time exhibitors, passionate learners and experienced professionals, creating a space for diverse artistic practices and perspectives.

The title Aurae Elemental reflects the exhibition's focus on the energy and presence surrounding artworks and the raw, instinctive nature of creativity. "Aurae" refers to the subtle energies associated with each work, while "Elemental" represents creativity in its pure and unrefined form. The exhibition explores how artistic expression takes shape through instinct, intuition and creative impulse.

Bringing together painters, sculptors, visual artists, designers, art educators, installation artists, digital artists and practitioners from various disciplines, the exhibition presents a range of mediums, approaches and artistic journeys.

span of time because I made sure the clay model was perfect in shape. This allowed me to easily weld the nuts and bolts according to my requirements," he says.

The contrast between the two sculptures also points to Sooriyamoorthy's larger approach to materials. Stone remains his favourite, largely because of the difficulty involved in working with it. Fibre is comparatively easier, he says, while metal and stone require greater time and effort. That difficulty, rather than convenience, appears to be what keeps him experimenting. As he gets the two sculptures ready for Aurae Elemental, the material is as much a part of the work as the form it eventually takes.



30 schools take part in management conclave

This is the silver jubilee edition of the inter-school event organised by the Department of Business Administration, Madras Christian College

Victory Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Thiruvottiyur emerged as the overall winner at the inter-school management conclave conducted by the Department of Business Administration, Madras Christian College.

This is the silver jubilee edition of its flagship inter-school management conclave, 'Exousia 2026', which drew over 30 schools from across Chennai, giving students a platform to explore business, entrepreneurship, and management through competitive and experiential activities.

This year's conclave revolved around the theme 'Humanize: The Human Synergy'. Centered on 'The New Business Model - Automated, Yet Human', Exousia spotlighted

one of the most pressing challenges in contemporary business: how organizations can leverage artificial intelligence and automation while preserving the human values that ensure meaningful, ethical, and sustainable growth.

S. Alfred Devaprasad, chief executive officer of Christwood Schools and an MCC board member, was the chief guest.

He inspired the gathering with insights on leadership in the digital age, stressing the need for creativity, empathy, and responsible choices alongside technological progress.

The inaugural also witnessed the release of Acumen, the department's annual student magazine.

In 'Product Verse', students showcased their ability to design packaging concepts that balanced sustainability with consumer appeal. The 'Shark Tank' round gave budding entrepreneurs the chance to pitch bold business ideas before a panel, while management gestures challenged teams to communicate management concepts through imaginative non-verbal expression.

The business quiz tested participants' knowledge of brands, markets, and corporate trends, adding a competitive edge to the conclave.



During the event. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Conference on green chemistry held

A two-day national conference on 'New Trends in Green Chemistry and Sustainable Environment' was held recently at the BSA Crescent Institute of Science and Technology in Vandalur.

Sponsored by the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) and the Tamil Nadu State Council for Science and Technology (TNSCST), the event brought top scientists, researchers, and

green-tech industry experts to tackle growing climate and environmental challenges.

The conference focused on creating a cleaner future.

Key topics discussed included eco-friendly chemical manufacturing, reducing hazardous waste, recycling advancements, and sustainable materials designed to support green energy.

Experts noted that while public demand for eco-friendly products

is at an all-time high, scientists must invent newer, safer chemical processes to build a fully circular economy. Academic scholars presented major research papers detailing new developments. These included eco-friendly food packaging made from biodegradable plants, advanced nanotechnology to clean polluted water systems, leather processing, waste-to-value-added products, and green energy conversion and storage.

Hope for people with knee osteoarthritis

Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals has started a "knee-preservation-first approach" to treat advanced osteoarthritis.

Dr. Deepak Kumar K S, an orthopaedic surgeon and a knee replacement and Mako Stryker expert, carefully evaluates every patient and explores appropriate treatment options to preserve the natural knee before considering replacement surgery, said a release.

Dr. Deepak has collaborated

with Dr. Sathish Kumar Thangamani, a senior assistant professor at Stanley Medical College and consultant at Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, to administer allogeneic bone marrow-derived mesenchymal stem cell therapy for select patients with knee osteoarthritis.

In a release, Dr Deepak says, "Wherever clinically appropriate, I believe in exploring every possible avenue to preserve the patient's natural knee."

Velammal Nexus honours teachers with awards

Velammal Nexus felicitated its teachers with service awards and academic excellence awards for their outstanding contributions.

To mark their commitment and achievements, the school presented prizes worth ₹70 lakh. Correspondent M. V. M. Velmohan handed over the cheque to the senior in-charges representing all Velammal Nexus schools on behalf of the awardees.

Wildlife photography contest

The Rotary Club of Chennai Crown, in partnership with Madras Photobloggers, is organising 'Yaavarum 2026', a contest for the speech and hearing impaired.

The contest aims to promote wildlife protection through nature conservation and encourage participants to explore, observe, and capture the beauty and importance of the natural world through their own lens.

The contest is open to first-time photographers.

Entries will be accepted till September 30. Each participant may submit up

to three photographs, taken with either a mobile phone or a camera. However, AI-generated images will not be permitted.

Winners will be honoured during 'Wildlife Week 2026' in October. The public is requested to share information about the contest with deaf and hard-of-hearing friends, communities, networks, colleges, and institutions for deaf students.

For registration, log on to <https://forms.gle/btUHVUDYd26UgZpi8>, a press release said.

Special sweet boxes for Ganesh Chaturthi

Sri Krishna Sweets is bringing special sweets and savouries boxes for Ganesh Chaturthi. Each box includes mysurpa, laddu, sweet kozhukattai, adhirasam, sweet seva, aval mixture and kara kozhukattai. With this box, one will receive a Vinayagar clay statue and prasadam. The special boxes will be available on September 13 and 14 at all their outlets. On September 14, hot sweet and kara kozhukattai will be available in various outlets including Chrompet GST Road, Guduvanchery, Madipakkam, Medavakkam, Sembakkam, Tambaram West and Velachery from 9 a.m. to 1 p.m.

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN

Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787



TAMIL
ONLINE TUITION
ALL GRADES
ALL BOARDS
GRAMMAR • LITERATURE
EXAM PREPARATION
ONE-TO-ONE CLASSES
FLEXIBLE TIMINGS
BASIC TAMIL LEARNING
FOR BEGINNERS
ENQUIRIES 98408 81518

BUYING
BEST PRICE
Very Old Rosewood, Teakwood
Antique Furniture, Antique Watches
Wooden Art, Brass Art, Paintings
Kolu Toys, Silk Saree, Old Coins
Antique Pen, Clock, Vintage items
All Rare Collectibles
98408 20587

STACK PARKING
TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
CUSTOMIZABLE, COST-EFFECTIVE
MULTI-LEVEL CAR PARKING
Street parking ends here.
Park inside. Stay safe.
No Sun, No Rain, No Risk
98414 46022 / 044-24450357

KALAIVANI
OLD AGE HOME
@
EAST TAMBARAM
Contact:
98843 67968
89392 76861

பலப்பை, வண்டலூர்,
கடுவாஞ்சேரி பகுதியில்
விடுகட்ட அணுகவும்
K R CONSTRUCTIONS
BUILDING CONTRACTOR
& ENGINEER
BUDGET FRIENDLY
BUILDERS
PLANS
CONSTRUCTION
LABOUR CONTRACT
8072 499969

MARUTI SUZUKI
ARENA
For Service Booking Call
AUTO TECH
Ph : 97100 11888
044 - 223 88888
No.6,1st Street,
Kamatchi Colony,
Sanatorium,
Chennai 600 047.

Social media opening doors to child marriages?

On September 4, 2026, the United Nations General Assembly declared November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage. Child rights activists in Chennai weigh in on what it takes, particularly in the online space, to counter the evil of child marriage

LIFY THOMAS

Last year, the District Child Welfare Committee in Chennai dealt with a case where a 15-year-old girl from Nepal had married a 28-year-old man working in Chennai, the two having met on Instagram. With the help of friends, they got married in Chennai.

A month into the marriage, the girl was traced after she made a call to her sister in Nepal. The girl's family lodged a complaint with the police following which India Child Protection, a civil society organisation working in the area of child protection, intervened to rescue the girl.

Social media and online dating are increasingly exposing vulnerable girls to greater risk of child marriage.

"With advancement in digital communication, the *modus operandi* in child marriage is changing, making more children vulnerable," says Bhuwan Ribhu, a child rights activist and founder of Just Rights for Children.

Bhuwan Ribhu says trafficking is a borderless crime, and it requires a borderless response. Online methods of enticement or grooming for marriage, sexual abuse and trafficking have become possible irrespective of distance and geography.

In a study taken by NGO Save the Children, they observed that girls in India faced greater online risk of child marriage and trafficking during the pandemic. The agency continues to work with children and teachers to raise awareness about staying safe online.

According to the National Family Health Survey (2019-21), the national average in India for child marriage is 23%. The prevalence rate in India for child marriage has fallen by 10 per cent. The Bal Vivah Mukta Bharat campaign launched by the Central Government in November 2024 promises to make India child marriage-free by 2030 and is seeing various state governments running different initiatives.

A dedicated CMPO needed

Natharsha Malim H, state coordinator - Tamil Nadu, India Child Protection, says while Tamil Nadu has been making steady progress in reporting and stopping child marriages, gaps continue to exist.

Tamil Nadu, he says, does not have Child Marriage Prohibition Officers (CMPOs) that are appointed to prevent marriages, gather evidence, raise awareness and report data. The District Social Welfare Officer (DSWO) is notified as the Child Marriage Prohibition Officer of the concerned district.

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R KUMAR

"This is an additional role that the DSWO takes up. We have been asking for a dedicated person to be appointed as many other states have done

based on a Supreme Court recommendation," says Malim.

For example, in Karnataka, the Department of Women and Child Welfare has included pre-university (PU) college principals as child marriage prohibition officers, whose responsibility is to prevent any girl child studying in their college from marrying before 18 years.

Dedicated officials tasked with curbing this practice is particularly required in places such as Salem, Dindigul, Namakkal and Cuddalore which has reported maximum cases of child marriages, says Malim. Grama panchayats have to be empowered in these districts to curb child marriage

A rule book for intervention

Malim notes that State Governments have to draw up a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for elimination of child marriages.

"The Supreme Court came out with a landmark judgement on child marriages in October 2024, but Tamil Nadu is yet to come out with an SOP," he says.

Panchayats that make an earnest effort to stop child marriage should be rewarded; and the bravery of young girls that resist coercion by family into child marriage should also be acknowledged.

Bhuwan Ribhu cites the example of a study done by India Child Protection in 2025, wherein cases in Assam dropped by 84 percent following a continuous crackdown by law-enforcement authorities.

Although Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 has been in existence for decades, enforcement leaves a lot to be desired.

"With amendments to the law and judgments by the Supreme Court, we have been able to see much impact on the ground, along with greater awareness," says Ribhu, adding, "awareness needs to be supplemented with the enforcement of policies, accountability of institutions, and the use of technology for monitoring."



Residents association in Chennai hails UN declaration



On September 4, 2026, when the United Nations General Assembly declared November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage, a residents group in Anna Nagar celebrated the announcement.

A small number of residents, close to 150, of Kambar Colony in Anna Nagar gathered at the park in the neighbourhood to watch the live proceedings of the United Nations General Assembly on the designation of November 27 as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage.

The programme was organised by the ICWO Tamil Nadu and Kambar Colony Welfare Association. The designation is a significant global commitment to strengthening awareness, prevention and action against child, early and forced marriage. This is a victory for children and civil society organisations that have been fighting to end child marriage.

Awareness banners and charts were displayed, and the gathering concluded with an oath-taking ceremony to strengthen the community's commitment to end child marriage.

ICWO is a partner agency with Just Rights with Children in Chennai, working with educational institutions and communities on rights concerning children.

A.J. Hariharan, founder secretary, ICWO, says reporting is the key to preventing child marriage. He notes: "we work closely with schools and colleges to help eradicate child marriage. All what we ask them is report any cases of child marriage to the helpline number or a teacher."

How to report a child marriage

File a complaint with

Child Marriage Prohibition Officer

District Magistrate
Nearest police station

District Child Protection Unit

ASHA Unit of District Legal Services Authority

Bal Vivah Mukta Bharat portal
<https://stopchildmarriage.wcd.gov.in>

Source: Ministry of Women and Child Development

